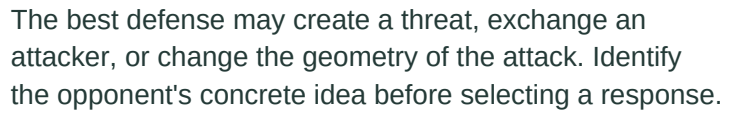


Active defensive resources

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires.
Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

Previous move: 18.Kh1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

18...Rxf1+ 19. Nxf1 Rf8 20. Ng3 Re8

18...Rxf1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f1 it attacks king on h1 and bishop on c1. Recorded reply:
19.Nxf1.

19...Rf8 The rook moves from a8 to f8. Recorded reply: **20.Ng3**.

20...Re8 The rook moves from f8 to e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.